

Session 35: Reflecting on the Armor of God

Key Takeaways

- The snake is always present when we choose between the old humanity and the new humanity.
- The powers want to persuade us that our real identity, value, and destiny is based on something other than Jesus' death and resurrection, the gift of his Spirit, and our unity as the new humanity. We resist the powers with the true reality of Jesus.
- Truth is not an idea that you need to learn. Truth is a person you must encounter.

Conclusion: Translation and Literary Design of Ephesians 6:21-24

²¹ So that y'all also might know how things are with me,
what I'm doing,
Tychicus will make everything known to y'all,
that beloved brother
and faithful servant in the Lord,
²² whom I sent to y'all for this reason,
so that y'all might know how things are with us
and that he might comfort y'all's hearts.

²³ Peace to the brothers and sisters,
and love
with faith,
from God the Father
and from Lord Jesus the Messiah.

²⁴ Grace be with all who love our Lord Jesus Messiah
with incorruptible [love].

Ephesians 6:21-24. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Ephesians (2019).

Resources on Ephesians

Commentaries

General and accessible, comments paragraph by paragraph:

- N. T. Wright, [*Paul for Everyone: The Prison Letters: Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, and Philemon*](#)

More detailed, comments verse by verse in expositional form:

- Ben Witherington III, [*The Letters to Philemon, the Colossians, and the Ephesians: A Socio-Rhetorical Commentary on the Captivity Epistles*](#)
- John Stott, [*The Message of Ephesians \(The Bible Speaks Today\)*](#)

Other Books on Ephesians

- Timothy G. Gombis, [*The Drama of Ephesians: Participating in the Triumph of God*](#)

Resources on the Household Code of Ephesians 5

- Cynthia Long Westfall, [*Paul and Gender: Reclaiming the Apostle's Vision for Men and Women in Christ*](#)
- Philip Barton Payne, [*Man and Woman, One in Christ*](#)

Introductions to Paul

- Michael Gorman, [*Apostle of the Crucified Lord: A Theological Introduction to Paul and His Letters*](#)
- Timothy G. Gombis, [*Paul: A Guide for the Perplexed*](#)
- N. T. Wright, [*Paul: A Biography*](#)
- E. Randolph Richards, [*Paul and First-Century Letter Writing: Secretaries, Composition, and Collection*](#)

Reflection Question

Read the last four verses of the letter to the Ephesians ([Eph. 6:21-24](#)). Now that you've reached the end of the letter and the class, how would you summarize the main idea of the book of Ephesians? Try to keep it to just a few sentences.